

Manual 2

Billing FAQ & Payment Support Manual

AI Customer Support Knowledge Base

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Department: Customer Support Operations

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1. Introduction

Billing-related queries are among the most common requests received by customer support teams. Customers expect clear explanations regarding invoices, payments, due dates, late fees, discounts, and refunds.

This manual provides standardized procedures to help support agents resolve billing issues efficiently while maintaining excellent customer satisfaction.

2. Purpose

The objectives of this manual are to:

- Ensure accurate billing support.
- Reduce Average Handling Time (AHT).
- Improve First Contact Resolution (FCR).
- Standardize payment-related responses.
- Minimize unnecessary escalations.

3. Scope

This manual covers:

- Monthly invoices
- Duplicate charges
- Failed payments
- Late payment fees
- Payment confirmations
- Invoice requests
- Subscription changes
- Billing disputes
- Refund requests

4. Agent Responsibilities

Customer Support Representatives must:

- Verify customer identity.
- Review account billing history.
- Explain invoice details clearly.
- Maintain professionalism.
- Document every interaction.
- Escalate complex billing issues when necessary.

5. Billing Cycle Overview

Standard Monthly Billing Process

1. Invoice generated automatically.
2. Invoice emailed to customer.
3. Payment due within billing period.
4. Reminder sent before due date.
5. Late fee applied after grace period.
6. Service suspension (if applicable).

Invoice Components

Each invoice contains:

- Customer Name
- Customer ID
- Billing Month

- Subscription Plan
- Additional Charges
- Discounts
- Taxes
- Previous Balance
- Total Amount Due
- Due Date

Agents should review every section before responding to customer questions.

6. Payment Methods

Customers can pay using:

- Credit Card
 - Debit Card
 - UPI
 - Internet Banking
 - Mobile Wallet
 - Auto Debit
 - Bank Transfer
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Payment Confirmation

Successful payments generate:

- Transaction ID
- Payment Receipt
- Confirmation Email

- Updated Account Balance

If payment confirmation is delayed:

- Verify transaction status.
 - Check payment gateway.
 - Inform customer of processing time.
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7. Common Billing Issues

Issue 1: Higher Than Expected Bill

Possible reasons:

- Plan upgrade
- Additional usage charges
- Taxes
- Previous outstanding balance

Resolution:

- Explain invoice breakdown.
 - Clarify additional charges.
 - Verify billing calculations.
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Issue 2: Failed Payment

Possible causes:

- Bank declined transaction
- Insufficient balance
- Incorrect card information
- Network issue

Resolution:

- Ask customer to retry.
 - Suggest alternate payment method.
 - Verify transaction ID.
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Issue 3: Duplicate Payment

Procedure:

- Verify both transactions.
 - Confirm duplicate charge.
 - Initiate refund if applicable.
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Issue 4: Invoice Not Received

Actions:

- Verify registered email.
 - Check spam folder.
 - Resend invoice.
 - Confirm successful delivery.
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Issue 5: Late Payment Fee

Explain:

- Due date
- Grace period
- Company policy
- Fee calculation

If system error occurred:
Raise Billing Investigation.

8. Standard Billing Resolution Procedure

Step 1

Verify customer identity.

Confirm:

- Customer ID
 - Registered Mobile Number
 - Email Address
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Step 2

Review account history.

Check:

- Previous invoices
 - Payment history
 - Pending balance
 - Active subscription
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Step 3

Identify issue category.

Examples:

- Payment Failure
- Refund

- Invoice Request
 - Duplicate Charge
 - Billing Error
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Step 4

Provide explanation.

Use simple language.

Avoid financial jargon.

Always confirm customer understanding.

Step 5

Complete necessary action.

Possible actions include:

- Resend invoice
 - Record payment
 - Raise refund request
 - Open billing investigation
 - Escalate case
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9. Refund & Adjustment Process

Refunds may be issued for:

- Duplicate payments
- Billing errors
- Cancelled subscriptions

- Service interruptions
- Incorrect charges

Refund Timeline

Payment Method Processing Time

Credit Card	5–7 Business Days
Debit Card	5–7 Business Days
UPI	1–3 Business Days
Bank Transfer	5–10 Business Days

Required Information

Before initiating a refund:

- Customer ID
- Order ID
- Transaction ID
- Refund Reason
- Payment Date

10. Escalation Guidelines

Escalate if:

- Duplicate billing confirmed.
- High-value refund required.
- Payment gateway error.
- Invoice generated incorrectly.

- Customer disputes charges.
- Fraud suspected.

Always include:

- Customer Details
 - Billing History
 - Payment Records
 - Investigation Notes
 - Screenshots (if applicable)
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11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. Why is my bill higher this month?

Possible reasons include additional usage charges, taxes, previous outstanding balances, or subscription upgrades.

Q2. Can I receive a duplicate invoice?

Yes.

Invoices can be resent through:

- Email
 - Customer Portal
 - Mobile App
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Q3. My payment failed.

Please verify:

- Card details
- Bank balance

- Network connectivity

If the issue continues, try another payment method.

Q4. How long does a refund take?

Most refunds are completed within 5–7 business days depending on the payment method.

Q5. Can late fees be removed?

Late fees are applied according to company policy.

Agents should escalate exceptional cases for manager approval.

12. Sample Customer Conversations

Scenario 1

Customer

"My bill is much higher than last month."

Agent

"I understand your concern. Let me review your invoice and explain each charge so we can identify the reason for the increase."

Scenario 2

Customer

"My payment failed even though I have enough money."

Agent

"I apologize for the inconvenience. Let me verify the transaction status while you remain on the line."

Scenario 3

Customer

"I accidentally paid twice."

Agent

"Thank you for informing us. I'll verify both transactions and initiate the refund process if a duplicate payment is confirmed."

13. Best Practices

Always:

- Verify account before discussing billing.
- Explain charges clearly.
- Maintain transparency.
- Confirm customer understanding.
- Record all actions.

Never:

- Guess invoice information.
 - Promise refunds without verification.
 - Share confidential billing information.
 - Close billing disputes prematurely.
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14. Agent Checklist

Before closing the interaction, verify:

- ☒ Customer identity confirmed
- ☒ Billing history reviewed

- ☒ Invoice explained
 - ☒ Payment status verified
 - ☒ Required action completed
 - ☒ Refund initiated (if applicable)
 - ☒ Escalation created (if required)
 - ☒ Notes documented
 - ☒ Customer informed of next steps
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Document Control

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